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1. DE STAAT - FREEDOM (Official Music Video)
Source: Simon Willison’s Weblog | Published: 2026-10-22T19:42:26+00:00
Link: https://simonwillison.net/2026/Oct/22/de-staat-freedom/
DE STAAT - FREEDOM (Official Music Video) OK well this is a first for me... at 00:44 in this new music video by Dutch alternative rock band De Staat : The visual effects are credited to Matties Grooten of Fake it or Leave it . Via flir on Hacker News Tags: music , ai , generative-ai , pelican-riding-a-bicycle

2. Donating Agent Skills to the Agentic AI Foundation
Source: Simon Willison’s Weblog | Published: 2026-10-22T18:09:56+00:00
Link: https://simonwillison.net/2026/Oct/22/donating-agent-skills/
Donating Agent Skills to the Agentic AI Foundation News today from Anthropic: We?re committed to keeping Agent Skills open, community-driven, and vendor-neutral. Today, we are donating the standard to the Agentic AI Foundation (AAIF) under the Linux Foundation, which we co-founded with Block and OpenAI last year, and to which we donated the Model Context Protocol (MCP). I’m pleased to note I called this one last December , when Anthropic first declared skills to be an "open standard": I wouldn’t be surprised to see this end up in the AAIF , recently the new home of the MCP specification. Fun side note: since my blog content is available to Claude via the datasette-mcp plugin I found that post by prompting Claude to " Use simonwillison.net MCP to find if I ever talked about how I want skills to be donated to a standards body ". Tags: standards , ai , generative-ai , llms , anthropic , model-context-protocol , skills

3. Quoting Armin Ronacher
Source: Simon Willison’s Weblog | Published: 2026-10-22T15:34:13+00:00
Link: https://simonwillison.net/2026/Oct/22/armin-ronacher/
As fun as AI is, we built so much bad software over the last 30 years, and now the universe is punishing us for our sins. ? Armin Ronacher Tags: security , generative-ai , armin-ronacher , ai , ai-security-research , llms

4. Apple Highlights 50+ iPhone Apps That Have Already Been Optimized for the Duo
Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-10-22T19:10:10Z
Link: https://www.apple.com/newsroom/2026/10/developers-bring-incredible-new-app-experiences-to-iphone-duo/
Apple Newsroom: New editorial collections for iPhone Duo apps and games will go live on the App Store this Friday, with additional app updates rolling out throughout the year. Apps optimized for iPhone Duo are easy to identify with a Made for iPhone Duo badge on product pages across the storefront. This story highlights dozens of apps that have been optimized. This sort of transition happens every time Apple introduces a major screen change. It happened with the iPhone X in 2017, it happened when the iPhone 6 added a Plus size, it happened when the iPhone 5 changed the aspect ratio from 3:2 to 16:9, and, most memorably of all, it happened when the iPhone 4 went retina. Every time this happens it sucks to some varying degree of suckiness to use apps that haven?t been optimized. And soon enough, all apps still under active development get updated. Developers know that iPhone users care how apps look and work. iPhone users will switch to competing apps for something like this. I stopped checking Mastodon on my phone for the last week and half because Ivory isn?t optimized. I stopped reading my messages on Signal ? I just wait until I?m back at my desk. If I bought a Duo, I?d literall...

5. Updates to My iPhone Duo Review
Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-10-22T18:49:38Z
Link: https://daringfireball.net/2026/10/the_iphone_duo
Nothing major, but since publishing at 7:00pm last night, I?ve made a few additions and changes to my iPhone Duo review. I?m calling them out here, so that if you?ve already read it, you can

see the changes. If I make more, I?ll add them to the top. Regarding the camera, added and/or clarified the following (in bold): As for the camera itself, it?s terrific. It?s clearly not of the same caliber as the iPhone 18 Pro, but it?s good. The technical specs of the Duo?s main 1⁄2×camera are nearly identical to those of the year-ago iPhone Air, and I love the iPhone Air?s camera . If anything, the Duo?s camera should be better, because it gets the year-better A20 Pro imaging pipeline. Which, notably, brings support for the same new Photographic Styles, including textures like film grain, that were introduced with the iPhone 18 Pro . However, the Duo is not ?Pro? ? it does not get camera features like ?Pro controls? (variable lens aperture, shutter speed, white balance, histogram), Apple Reference Image , spatial video, ProRES (video or RAW), or Apple Log. Apple?s ?shot with iPhone? keynotes will continue to use iPhones Pro. Also, notably different from the Air, the Duo has an ultrawide...

6. Time Magazine Profiles John Ternus
Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-10-19T16:17:14Z
Link: https://time.com/collection/best-inventions/2026/apple-iphone-duo/
Andrew Chow, writing for Time: Just below the broad smile he?s been wearing all morning, John Ternus? hands are shaking. On this September day in Silicon Valley, Apple?s new CEO is surrounded by celebrities, tech enthusiasts, and reporters who have flocked to Apple Park from around the world to catch a glimpse of the company?s new and long-awaited foldable phone, the Duo. After Ternus takes a few photos with the device, an Apple PR rep pulls the influencer known as IShowSpeed out of the crowd to meet him. Winning over the 21-year-old isn?t exactly the toughest assignment Ternus has faced in his 25-year Apple career: Speed barks when he sees the phone and then gleefully springs into a backflip. But IShowSpeed also happens to be livestreaming the encounter to his 61 million subscribers on YouTube. And as Ternus thumbs through the $1,999-and-up phone, attempting to drag a photo into a text-message box, eagle-eyed viewers notice his hands quivering. Ternus later explains that he didn?t sleep much the night before. ?I was on such a moment of adrenaline and caffeine and excitement for the day,? he tells Time. There?s only a glimpse of Ternus?s personality revealed here. To date he?s mor...

7. Productivity
Source: Software and Tech stories from an Insider - iDiallo.com | Published: Thu, 22 Oct 2026 16:56:14 GMT
Link: https://idiallo.com/byte-size/productivity-video
I’d say in a given week I probably only do about fifteen minutes of real, actual, work. ? Office Space I was watching a video where a guy said he has 8 agents working in the background. He was stressed out and was trying to "get shit done." At one point he said "I have no time to myself." That was very confusing. Let’s assume for a second that the AI agents were doing all the work for him. Maybe it was some tedious work that would have taken him so much time to do manually. Now, he doesn’t have to do the work because someone else is doing it. Why is he still busy? The Future we were promised It seems like the goal of productivity is to reduce the amount of work needed to create a set of results. But the moment you create the same results in less time, you are incentivised to use the new gained time to produce even more results. You will rest when you grow up ? My Mom. But now that we are grown up, our employer changed the tune just a bit: You will rest when you are dead.

8. Software is slow because of bad design, not slow languages
Source: seangoedecke.com RSS feed | Published: Fri, 23 Oct 2026 00:00:00 GMT
Link: https://seangoedecke.com/software-is-slow-because-of-bad-design-not-slow-languages/
Many people are saying that AI will make software faster by rewriting it in faster languages, but this isn?t generally true. Most programs cannot be meaningfully sped up by rewriting them in C or Rust. How can this be true? Some languages are orders-of-magnitude faster than others: for instance, C can be fifty times faster than Python. Won?t rewriting my Python program in C thus make it fifty times faster? No, it won?t. Software performance is usually dominated by I/O, not the speed of the language. Where language speed matters, most slow languages already have popular libraries that allow them to unlock C-like speed. In general, performance is a

matter of design , not of language choice. Most real programs are I/O-bound Consider a simple CRUD website with a database. For any given request, 50% of the request time 1 might be spent querying the database: to fetch the current user, the record being asked for, any relevant user memberships or settings, and so on. Rewriting that website in C can only speed up that other 50%, which puts a hard ceiling on the improvements you can make 2 . At best, you?ll make requests twice as fast (probably closer to 1.5x in practice). That?s not bad,...

9. "No way to prevent this" say users of only language where this regularly happens
Source: Xe Iaso’s blog | Published: Thu, 22 Oct 2026 00:00:00 GMT
Link: https://xeiaso.net/shitposts/no-way-to-prevent-this/memory-safety/CVE-2026-93479/
In the hours following the release of CVE-2026-93479 for the project NGINX , site reliability workers and systems administrators scrambled to desperately rebuild and patch all their systems to fix a heap buffer overflow in worker script evaluation triggered by crafted requests when regex map captures are referenced before the map output, or when a non-cacheable variable is used in certain string expressions, causing worker restarts and potentially code execution if ASLR is disabled or bypassed. This is due to the affected components being written in C, the only programming language where these vulnerabilities regularly happen. "This was a terrible tragedy, but sometimes these things just happen and there’s nothing anyone can do to stop them," said programmer Mr. Mariano Franecki, echoing statements expressed by hundreds of thousands of programmers who use the only language where 90% of the world’s memory safety vulnerabilities have occurred in the last 50 years, and whose projects are 20 times more likely to have security vulnerabilities. "It’s a shame, but what can we do? There really isn’t anything we can do to prevent memory safety vulnerabilities from happening if the programm...

10. "No way to prevent this" say users of only language where this regularly happens
Source: Xe Iaso’s blog | Published: Wed, 21 Oct 2026 00:00:00 GMT
Link: https://xeiaso.net/shitposts/no-way-to-prevent-this/memory-safety/CVE-2026-107891/
In the hours following the release of CVE-2026-107891 for the project musl , site reliability workers and systems administrators scrambled to desperately rebuild and patch all their systems to fix multiple integer overflows in regcomp() when compiling untrusted regular expressions, leading to undersized allocations and possible out-of-bounds heap writes, denial of service, and arbitrary code execution. This is due to the affected components being written in C, the only programming language where these vulnerabilities regularly happen. "This was a terrible tragedy, but sometimes these things just happen and there’s nothing anyone can do to stop them," said programmer Dr. Otho Conroy, echoing statements expressed by hundreds of thousands of programmers who use the only language where 90% of the world’s memory safety vulnerabilities have occurred in the last 50 years, and whose projects are 20 times more likely to have security vulnerabilities. "It’s a shame, but what can we do? There really isn’t anything we can do to prevent memory safety vulnerabilities from happening if the programmer doesn’t want to write their code in a robust manner." At press time, users of the only programmi...

11. Jesus Christ patch your shit now
Source: Xe Iaso’s blog | Published: Wed, 21 Oct 2026 00:00:00 GMT
Link: https://xeiaso.net/shitposts/no-way-to-prevent-this/memory-safety/CVE-2026-109618/
In the hours following the release of CVE-2026-109618 for the project PHP , site reliability workers and systems administrators scrambled to desperately rebuild and patch all their systems to fix multiple memory safety vulnerabilities that allow attackers to execute arbitrary code on your server. This isn’t something you can just mitigate and be fine. You MUST patch this. Don’t try to bargain here. This is due to the affected components being written in C, the only programming language where these vulnerabilities regularly happen. "This was a terrible tragedy, but sometimes these things just happen and there’s nothing anyone can do to stop them," said programmer Lady Miracle Kreiger, echoing statements expressed by hundreds of thousands of programmers who use the only language where 90% of the world’s memory safety vulnerabilities have occurred in the last 50 years, and whose projects are 20 times more likely to have security vulnerabilities. "It’s a shame, but what can we do? There really isn’t

anything we can do to prevent memory safety vulnerabilities from happening if the programmer doesn’t want to write their code in a robust manner." At press time, users of the only programm...

12. Working around a strange Python problem
Source: John D. Cook | Published: Thu, 22 Oct 2026 15:12:10 +0000
Link: https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/10/22/pep-723/
A Python script that worked a few days ago wouldn?t work today. I suspect it might have something to do with my updating everything I could think of in response to recent security breaches. I got an error message that said error: The script contains multiple PEP 723 metadata blocks I searched on what that [?] The post Working around a strange Python problem first appeared on John D. Cook .

13. How the eMudrha certificate debacle might have happened
Source: John D. Cook | Published: Thu, 22 Oct 2026 14:01:55 +0000
Link: https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/10/22/certificate-debacle/
You may have seen references to a password being the number 4. There are countless allusions to this online, but they don?t give the context. As I mentioned in an earlier post, eMudrha was using the numbers 4, 56, 115, 155, 156, 230, and 237 as secret keys. I haven?t seen details of how this [?] The post How the eMudrha certificate debacle might have happened first appeared on John D. Cook .

14. The number of points on an elliptic curve
Source: John D. Cook | Published: Thu, 22 Oct 2026 11:08:51 +0000
Link: https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/10/22/the-number-of-points-on-an-elliptic-curve/
An elliptic curve E over a finite field F consists of the set of points (x, y) satisfying the equation y† = x‡ + ax + b with x and y in F. Typically in cryptography the field F is the integers mod p where p is a very large prime number. The number of points on E is roughly the number [?] The post The number of points on an elliptic curve first appeared on John D. Cook .

15. Gadget Review: Mokin 17 Port USB-C Tower ?????
Source: Terence Eden?s Blog | Published: Thu, 22 Oct 2026 11:34:36 +0000
Link: https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/10/gadget-review-mokin-17-port-usb-c-tower/
The good folks at Mokin have sent me their new USB-C hub and it is a beast. This is the MODK2403 - the latest in their line of high-tech USB-C docks. It does close to everything you could want and has an LCD monitor for showing the weather. Errr? What? OK, a quick product shots, then on to the specs. On to the ports: Triple display Either 3x HDMI or 1x HDMI and 2x DisplayPort 4x U?

16. NYC, New Webinar, Differential Testing
Source: Computer Things | Published: Thu, 22 Oct 2026 15:14:05 +0000
Link: https://buttondown.com/hillelwayne/archive/nyc-new-webinar-differential-testing/
Been a while! Man, it’s so much harder to write essays for a newsletter when I have a full time job writing essays for a company. So three bits of housekeeping first of all: As of last month I now live in NYC! Let me know if you want to get coffee or have me swing by an office or something. I’m back on Twitter . Do not mourn me for I do not deserve it. My first big Antithesis deliverable is coming out next Thursday, and it’s a webinar on property-based testing . What’s going to make this one interesting is that it’s about property testing web applications . I’ve got this crazy idea that the main way to make randomized testing accessible and useful is to focus on state-based system invariants as opposed to algebraic laws and roundtrip properties. Send it to webdevs you know! 1 Anyway, to make this actually a newsletter and not just a bunch of updates, one thing I’ve been thinking about recently is nondeterministic differential testing . Say we have a python program and we tell a slopinator to convert it to rust. How do we know that it didn’t change the program’s behavior? For a totally deterministic program, this is straightforward differential testing : feed inputs into

both and c...

17. Script dependencies with Nix
Source: Entropic Thoughts | Published: Thu, 22 Oct 2026 00:00:00 +0200
Link: https://entropicthoughts.com/python-dependencies-with-nix
In the theme of NixOS enabling fearlessness, here?s a way I use Nix on other Linux distributions to sleep better at night: managing dependencies of simple scripts. This way of using Nix is for everyone, not just those willing to try NixOS. We?ll look at it first for a Python script, and then see how it can be adapted to any other language. I wanted to create a script that would read the verbatim content of my articles out loud to me with a synthesised voice. One of the more convenient ways to do this is with Python, where I?ve heard good things about Trafilatura for extracting the contents out of a web page, filtering on types of content, etc. But Trafilatura is a third-party Python dependency. Those suck because they break your scripts when you so much as glance sideways at pip . The code also ended up depending on aplay , which is a system dependency, making it two different sources of future breakage. A couple of years ago, I would probably have judged that to be too much maintenance, so I wouldn?t have created the script. Fortunately, now I know about Nix. (Continue reading the full article on the web.)

18. What will computer chips look like in 2045?
Source: Dwarkesh Podcast | Published: Thu, 22 Oct 2026 15:02:21 GMT
Link: https://www.dwarkesh.com/p/intel-tour
What I learned from touring Intel?s most advanced fab and talking to its leadership.

19. If people would just
Source: Herman’s blog | Published: 2026-10-22T12:21:05.048431+00:00
Link: https://herman.bearblog.dev/if-people-would-just/
People use the word just a lot when talking about problems. If people would just drive slowly near schools. If people would just pay their taxes. If people would just follow the rules. It’s a sentence that sounds reasonable as it’s true that most problems would go away if people just behaved. The thing is, they don’t...and they probably never will. This isn’t a cynical take on humanity (I think most people are decent). It’s about designing good systems. The vast majority of people who use Bear are there to write, and most drivers in my city stop at red lights. But "most" isn’t "all", and when you’re dealing with thousands (or millions) of people, a small percentage is still a lot of people. Let’s say 1% of people are going to misbehave. That doesn’t sounds like much, but if 10,000 people sign up for a service, that’s 100 people trying to break things. You can’t plan for the 99% and hope the 1% sorts itself out. The 1% is where all the work is. It’s also not always the same 1%. Decent people have bad days. Someone who usually stops at a red light might run it accidentally when they’re distracted and late for work. Some people genuinely don’t know how to recycle properly (a pet peev...